

City Council Meeting July 7th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n97GJEDTBIQ
Publication Date	2025-07-08T14:51:39Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Common Council & Tax Abatement Committee

Meeting Date: July 7, 2025

Body: Muncie Common Council (incorporating Pre-Meeting Tax Abatement Committee & Public Hearings)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** 00:00:00 Tax Abatement Committee Work Session reviewing Resolution 13-25 (Tax Abatement and PILOT agreement for Muncie Hotel Partners, LLC).
- **Summary of Discussion:**
 - Matt Anger, an attorney with Ice Miller LLP representing Muncie Hotel Partners, presented the project. The 10-year property tax abatement is tied to a Payment In Lieu Of Taxes (PILOT) agreement. The hotel project is a \$43 million capital investment to develop a hotel on a parcel previously owned by Ball State University and utilized as an exempt parking lot.
 - PILOT structure: Years 1<U+2013>5 at \$50,000 annually; Years 6<U+2013>10 at \$100,000 annually.
 - Projected employment: 50 new jobs generating approximately \$1.25 million in annual compensation (later updated to reflect 65% full-time/benefit-eligible and

- 35% part-time).
 - Council members raised concerns regarding local hiring, union labor participation, wage structures, and impacts on local taxing units (specifically Muncie Community Schools). Dr. Chuck Reynolds, CEO of Muncie Community Schools, submitted a statement supporting the project.
 - **Committee Recommendation:** 02:21:15 The Tax Abatement Committee voted to forward Resolution 13-25 to the full council with a favorable recommendation (with council member reservations noted regarding job makeup and local labor commitments).
-

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:44:34 Presiding officer called the regular meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order.
 - **Attendance:**
 - *Presiding Officer:* Council President
 - *Members Present:* Council Members Selvi, Powell, Garrett, Green, Basham, McIntosh, and Gillian (Note: Full attendance of 9 members referenced in Finance Committee reports).
 - *Members Absent:* None explicitly noted.
-

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:44:41 Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance, a moment of silence, and an opening invocation delivered by Minister William McIntyre.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:47:57 Motion to approve prior meeting minutes made by Councilman McIntosh, seconded by Councilman Green, and approved by voice vote.
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Appointments

- **Opioid Committee Nominations:** 00:51:05 Nominations opened for community members. Nominated and discussed:
 - *Corey Matters* (Clinical therapist, Open Door Health Services)
 - *Abby Glovna* (Executive director, Recovery Cafe Muncie)
 - *Neil Kring* (Neighborhood pastor and harm reduction specialist)
 - *Action:* Approved by Voice Vote.

- **Ethics Committee Nomination: 01:03:50** Nomination of *Frank Scott Jr.* to the Ethics Committee.
 - *Action:* Approved by Voice Vote **01:10:36**.
- **Beach Grove Cemetery Board of Trustees: 01:11:14** Reappointment of *Denise King*.
 - *Action:* Motion by Ms. Selvi, seconded by Mr. Garrett; Approved by Voice Vote **01:12:14**.

Ordinances & Resolutions (Previously Introduced)

- **01:12:29 Ordinance 19-25: Vacation of Public Right-of-Way**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* David Karnes (Attorney representing petitioners).
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Request to vacate a portion of an unimproved public street/alley at 401 South Lombard Drive and 400 South Terra Lane. Neighbors and petitioners testified on long-term property maintenance.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Adopted unanimously by roll call vote **01:16:25**.
- **01:16:54 Ordinance 20-25: Parks and Recreation Code Amendment**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* City Council.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Amending Chapter 95 (Section 95.09) of the Muncie Code of Ordinances. An amendment was introduced and seconded **01:17:52** to correct the spelling of former mayor Canan ("Canan commons").
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Adopted as amended by roll call vote **01:18:33**.
- **01:19:05 Ordinance 21-25: Parking Regulations Near The Village / Ball State University**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Councilman McIntosh / Councilman Garrett.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Amending parking regulations in the village to create more street parking to accommodate new developments.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Introduced/Adopted per meeting progression.
- **01:20:08 Ordinance 22-25: Zoning Map Amendment (2700 Block North Benton Road)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* David Karnes (Attorney for petitioner Mr. Dordy) / Councilwoman Gillian.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Proposal to rezone an unimproved parcel from R-1 (Residential) to R-5 (Residential) to allow construction of a triplex. Noted to receive a 9-0 favorable recommendation from the planning commission. Parking will be handled via private driveways.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Introduced/Adopted.
- **01:24:45 Ordinance 23-25: Zoning Map Amendment (2611 & 2619 West Ethel Ave / South Manning Ave)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* David Karnes / Councilwoman Powell.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Request to rezone properties (where blighted homes were demolished by the owner, Robert Housen) from R-5 to BV (Variety Business) to

square off property adjacent to the plaza. Received a 9-0 favorable recommendation from the planning commission.

- *Action & Vote Disposition*: Introduced/Adopted.
- **01:27:49 Ordinance 24-25: Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance Text Amendments**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter*: Kylie Swachhammer (Planning Commission) / Mayor's Office / Jim Lowe / Stephen Brand.
 - *Deliberation Summary*: Amending zoning text regarding lot width, lot coverage, setbacks, minimum floor area in R-1, R-2, and R-3 zones, and accessory dwelling units (ADUs) in R-4 zones to stimulate urban housing development. Modernizes standards last updated in 1973.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input / Debate*: Debate occurred regarding a motion to suspend the rules for an immediate vote **01:48:05**. While some council members supported immediate action to aid current developers, others opposed rushing without a 30-day public review.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition*: Introduced successfully. A motion to suspend the rules failed to achieve the necessary unanimous consensus, so the ordinance was held for subsequent adoption.
- **01:24:03 Ordinance 25-25: Emergency Medical Services Fees and Collections**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter*: Chief Dan Berford (Muncie Fire Department).
 - *Deliberation Summary*: Amending Chapter 35 (Section 22) regarding EMS fees in response to House Bill 1385 (effective Jan 1, 2025), which permits billing insurance at 400% of the published Medicare base rate. Reduces self-pay/uninsured rates by 60% and establishes a hardship petition process to the fire chief (with discussion to add a "designee"). Introduces "treat-no-transport" fees and Mobile Integrated Health (community paramedicine) billing structures.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition*: Introduced for review and future vote **02:11:31**.
- **02:11:53 Resolution 14-25: Tax Abatement & PILOT Confirmation for Muncie Hotel Partners, LLC**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter*: Matt Anger (Ice Miller LLP) / Mayor's Office.
 - *Deliberation Summary*: Confirming the economic revitalization area designation and tax abatement/PILOT agreement for the hotel project in the village. Updated workforce figures presented: 50 estimated jobs (65% full-time/benefit-eligible, 35% part-time).
 - *Item-Specific Public Input*: **02:22:19** Public commenter Rick Answer criticized the tax break, asserting lack of local/union labor and procedural waivers.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition*: Motion to adopt made by Mr. Basham, seconded by Mr. Garrett; Approved by Voice Vote.
- **02:25:38 Resolution 15-25: Community Center Study Committee**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter*: Council Member Green / Council Member Powell.
 - *Deliberation Summary*: Establishing a committee to study development of a community center to replace the former South Madison community center. Debated

and amended to include representatives from the Southside Neighborhood Association (President Courtney Marsh) and Morningside Neighborhood.

- *Action & Vote Disposition:* Amended and Adopted by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:35:46 Roger Overby (Morningside Neighborhood):** Highlighted neighborhood cleanups, park needs, vandalism issues, cameras, and drainage ditches; invited council members to their upcoming Saturday meeting.
- **02:41:53 Charlie James:** Expressed concern over the blighted appearance of the old Chevy plant property, noted parking deficiencies at Storey Estates, and recommended Jeremy Coons for the citizen of the month award for his graffiti cleanup efforts.
- **02:35:43 Judith Hill:** Raised traffic safety concerns on Madison Street and Memorial Drive/Martin Luther King Jr. corridor following recent road closures and accidents.
- **02:49:12 Ralph Privat (Granville Neighborhood Association):** Addressed code enforcement issues regarding front-yard parking and commercial vehicles/trailers in residential yards.
- **02:55:07 Christopher Barber:** Noted pedestrian safety hazards at the intersection of Wheeling Avenue and Bethel Avenue, specifically citing a lack of crosswalk markings near bus stops.
- **02:58:09 Amber Green (Director of Communications):** Provided an operational update on the launch of the Downtown Outdoor Refreshment Areas (DORAs), which went live ahead of the Ironman event.
- **03:03:22 Curtis Westbrook:** Followed up on prior inquiries regarding a citizen referendum for a city-owned and operated community center and criticized current municipal youth summer work program allocations.
- **03:11:30 Mayor Ridenour (Addressing Council):** Acknowledged community progress, the opening of the local skate park, and the collaborative success of the municipal youth employment program in partnership with the Parks Department and Teamwork.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Finance Committee budget workshop meeting with DLGF scheduled for July 31 at 9:00 AM.
 - DORA informational materials and district maps are live online at muncie.in.gov/dora.
 - **Adjournment:** **03:14:23** Official motion to adjourn made and seconded; meeting adjourned by voice vote.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-28 02:02:21 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.